

Page 04 — Reflect with me `/reflect.html`

Audited: 6 September 2026 · repository `bccody03/blog-site` @ `main` `c0a998a`

Live URL: `https://blakecody.com/reflect.html` — HTTP 200

Method: static HTML parse · headless Chromium render · form accessibility inspection (accessible-name computation per field) · read of the reflect submit path in `app.js` · cross-check against `privacy.html`

Status: Audit only — **no code changes applied**. Every entry is a proposed change with the exact edit.

12

CHANGES PROPOSED

3

HIGH

6

MEDIUM

3

LOW

Status Page-03 findings are still open **NOT YET IMPLEMENTED**

Unlike the previous two passes, `main` has not moved since `c0a998a`. The `book.html` findings — **T22** (the public, crawlable chapter PDF), **T23** (no `Book` schema), **C20/C21** (title and H1) — are outstanding.

Worth flagging because **T22** is the only Critical still open across the whole audit, and its ten-minute mitigation (`Disallow: /chapter-1.pdf` in `robots.txt`, drop the static `href`) is independent of the larger publish-or-gate decision.

Opportunity This is the most under-exploited page on the site

Every other page competes for something crowded — essays about discipline, a book about relationships, a personal brand. This one offers **free, one-to-one, personal replies from a real human being**, and the supply of that is genuinely thin.

It currently targets none of it. The title, the H1 and the URL all say "Reflect with me" — a phrase you coined, which means the only people who can find it by name are people who already know you. Everything in section B below is about closing that gap.

I am not going to give you a search volume — I have no keyword data and inventing one would be worse than useless. What I can say is that the intent exists and the page is currently invisible to it. Check Search Console's Performance report filtered to `/reflect.html`: if it shows only brand queries, or nothing at all, that is this finding measured.

Do these in this order

P0 — this week

1. **C27 C28** Title and H1 — the biggest single search opportunity on the site is behind a coined phrase
2. **T29** Add real `<label>` elements. There are currently zero on a page that is entirely a form.

P1 — this month

3. **T27** `Service` + `BreadcrumbList` schema — and here the offer is real, so it can be declared honestly
4. **C29** Add proof: one or two anonymised exchanges, with permission

5. **C31** Link the privacy policy at the send button, not just the footer
6. **C30** Heading order (H1 → H3 → H2 today)
7. **K18** Track form-start and chip selection, not just submits

P2

8. **T30 T31** `aria-pressed` on the topic chips; announce the success state
9. **T28** Plan for the day "Free for now" stops being true
10. **C32** Internal links for the reader who is not ready to write

A. Technical

T29 Not one `<label>` on a page that is entirely a form **HIGH**

NOW — MEASURED ACCESSIBLE NAMES

`<label>` elements on the page: 0

<code>#reflect-answer</code>	required	→	accessible name: PLACEHOLDER ONLY
<code>#reflect-name</code>	optional	→	accessible name: PLACEHOLDER ONLY
<code>#reflect-email</code>	required	→	accessible name: PLACEHOLDER ONLY

WHY IT MATTERS

Placeholders are not labels. They vanish the moment someone types, so anyone who pauses mid-form loses the only description of the field. They are announced inconsistently across screen readers. And they fail two WCAG criteria outright — 3.3.2 (Labels or Instructions) and 1.3.1 (Info and Relationships).

On most pages that is a moderate accessibility issue. Here the form *is* the page: every other element exists to get someone to fill it in.

FIX — AND YOU HAVE ALREADY WRITTEN THE LABEL

`<p class="reflect-prompt">What's on your mind?</p>` is sitting directly above the textarea doing a label's job without being one. Change the element:

```
<label class="reflect-prompt" for="reflect-answer">What's on your mind?</label>

<label class="sr-only" for="reflect-name">First name (optional)</label>
<label class="sr-only" for="reflect-email">Your email, so I can reply</label>

/* styles.css — if you do not already have it */
.sr-only { position:absolute; width:1px; height:1px; padding:0; margin:-1px;
           overflow:hidden; clip:rect(0 0 0 0); white-space:nowrap; border:0; }
```

Zero visual change. Keep the placeholders as hints — they are good ones — but they stop being the only label.

T27 No structured data — and this page can declare a real offer

MEDIUM

NOW

Measured: 0 JSON-LD blocks. Site-wide: `index.html` 5 nodes · `articles.html` 2 nodes · `book.html` 0 (T23, open) · `reflect.html` 0.

WHY THIS PAGE IS DIFFERENT FROM THE BOOK PAGE

On `book.html` I warned against adding `offers`, because the book is unpublished and any price or ISBN would be fabricated. **Here the opposite applies.** You are offering a real service that really exists and really is free — so `Service` with a zero-price `Offer` is an accurate statement, not a claim you would have to defend.

FIX

```
<script type="application/ld+json">
{
  "@context": "https://schema.org",
  "@graph": [
    { "@type": "Service",
      "@id": "https://blakecody.com/reflect.html#service",
      "name": "Reflect with me",
      "serviceType": "Personal reflection and coaching correspondence",
      "description": "Write in about anything on your mind – a question about your
        life and where it is headed, something you are stuck on – and
        get a personal written reply.",
      "provider": { "@id": "https://blakecody.com/#person" },
      "areaServed": "Worldwide",
      "availableChannel": {
        "@type": "ServiceChannel",
        "serviceUrl": "https://blakecody.com/reflect.html" },
      "offers": {
        "@type": "Offer",
        "price": "0",
        "priceCurrency": "USD",
        "availability": "https://schema.org/InStock" } },
    { "@type": "WebPage",
      "@id": "https://blakecody.com/reflect.html#webpage",
      "url": "https://blakecody.com/reflect.html",
      "isPartOf": { "@id": "https://blakecody.com/#website" },
      "about": { "@id": "https://blakecody.com/reflect.html#service" } },
    { "@type": "BreadcrumbList",
      "itemListElement": [
        { "@type": "ListItem", "position": 1, "name": "Home",
          "item": "https://blakecody.com/" },
        { "@type": "ListItem", "position": 2, "name": "Reflect with me" } ] }
  ]
}
```

One caution that leads straight into T28: `"price": "0"` is true today. The day it is not, this block is a false statement in machine-readable form, which is worse than a stale sentence on a page.

T28 "Free for now" appears in three places and nothing will catch it going stale

MEDIUM

NOW

Location	Text
<code><meta name="description"></code>	"... Free for now."
<code>og:description /</code> <code>twitter:description</code>	"... Free for now."
<code>.coaching-free</code> eyebrow	"Work with me · Free for now"
<code>.coaching-intro</code>	"I'm opening this up while I build my coaching practice... No cost."
and, if you add T27	<code>"price": "0"</code> in JSON-LD

Your own copy says this is temporary — "while I build my coaching practice". So the change is not hypothetical, it is planned. When it happens, five separate places need editing, and the one that matters most (the schema) is the one nobody will remember.

FIX

Nothing clever is needed — just make the change findable. Add a comment above the schema block naming every location:

```
<!-- PRICING: "free" is asserted in 5 places on this page – meta description,
og:description, twitter:description, the .coaching-free eyebrow, and
offers.price below. If this ever becomes paid, update all five. -->
```

If you would rather it be structural, drop `offers` from the schema entirely. `Service` without an `Offer` is still valid and says nothing that can become untrue.

T30 The topic chips do not expose their selected state LOW

NOW — MEASURED

```
.cat × 4    type="button"    aria-pressed: null    role: null
```

Selection is carried by an `.active` class and a hidden input. Visually it works. To a screen reader, all four chips are identical before and after a choice, so a user has no way to confirm which topic they picked — or that picking did anything.

The container is already correct: `role="group"` with `aria-label="Choose a topic"` ✓. Only the buttons are missing state.

FIX

```
<button type="button" class="cat" data-cat="Relationships"
  aria-pressed="false">Relationships</button>

// in the existing click handler in app.js
reflectCats.querySelectorAll(".cat").forEach((c) => {
  c.classList.remove("active");
  c.setAttribute("aria-pressed", "false");
});
if (!isActive) {
  chip.classList.add("active");
  chip.setAttribute("aria-pressed", "true");
  reflectCatInput.value = chip.dataset.cat;
}
```

T31 The success message is never announced LOW

NOW — MEASURED

```
#reflect-thanks    aria-live: null    role: null
```

On submit the form is hidden and the thanks block revealed. Sighted users see it and it scrolls into view. A screen reader user gets silence — the form they were filling in simply disappears, with no confirmation that anything was sent.

On a page where the whole interaction is "I told a stranger something personal, did it arrive?", that silence is a real cost.

FIX

```
<div class="reflect-thanks" id="reflect-thanks" role="status" hidden>
```

One attribute. `role="status"` carries an implicit `aria-live="polite"`, so the heading and message are read out when the block appears.

B. Content & text

C27 The title targets a phrase only you use HIGH

NOW

```
<title>Reflect with me – Blake Cody</title> 28 chars of ~60
```

"Reflect with me" is a good name. It is also a phrase you invented, which means the only people who can find this page by searching for it are people who already know it exists — and those people are already on your site.

Meanwhile the page offers something people genuinely look for and rarely find: a real person who will read what they write and answer, at no cost.

CHANGE TO

```
Free Coaching – Write to Me, I'll Reply Personally | Blake Cody 62 chars
```

Or, if "coaching" feels like more than you want to claim yet:

```
Ask Me Anything About Your Life – Free, Personal Reply | Blake Cody 66, trim to ~60
```

On honesty: "coaching" is accurate here — your own intro says "while I build my coaching practice" — so it is a description, not a stretch. Do not add "certified", "professional", or anything implying credentials you do not hold. The appeal of this page is precisely that it is a person rather than a practice, and overclaiming would trade the thing that makes it work for a word that would not help.

Keep "Reflect with me" as the nav label, the eyebrow and the brand for it. The `<title>` is not branding — it is the sentence a stranger reads in a results list.

C28 The H1 is the coined phrase too HIGH

NOW

```
<h1 class="coaching-title">Reflect with me</h1>
```

Fourth page in a row with this shape. The homepage and archive are fixed; the book page (C21) and this one are open.

CHANGE TO

```
<h1 class="coaching-title">Write to me about what's on your mind –  
I'll reply personally</h1>
```

Or shorter, if the type size fights you: Free, personal replies to whatever you're working through.

Either states the offer in the reader's language rather than yours, and both read naturally under the existing "Work with me · Free for now" eyebrow.

C29 166 words, and no evidence anyone has ever done this MEDIUM

NOW — MEASURED

```
static words in <body>: 166      rendered: 140
```

The intro is well written and honest. But the page asks a stranger to write something personal to someone they have never met, and then offers nothing to suggest that anyone has done it, that a reply actually arrives, or what a reply looks like.

Every other objection on this page is answered — cost (free), privacy (private), timing (a few days). The unanswered one is *is this real?*

FIX

One or two short anonymised exchanges. Not testimonials — an actual paraphrased question and the shape of what you wrote back:

```
<h2>What this usually looks like</h2>
<blockquote>Someone wrote in last month about staying in a relationship
they had already decided to leave...</blockquote>
<p>What I said back, roughly: ...</p>
```

Get permission first, always, and anonymise properly — no names, no identifying detail, and ideally paraphrase rather than quote. The trust this page runs on is the same trust you would be spending, so it is worth being conservative. If you are not comfortable using anyone's message, write a hypothetical and label it as one.

Three things at once: it is the social proof the page lacks, it is 200–300 words of indexable content on exactly the topics you want to own, and it is the most persuasive thing you could put here. Target 350–450 static words.

C30 Heading order runs H1 → H3 → H2 MEDIUM

NOW — MEASURED

```
H1  Reflect with me
H3  Got it. 🙏          the success card (hidden)
H2  Stay up to date in your inbox  the subscribe block
```

Same shape as `book.html` (T25). A level is skipped, then the order reverses, and nothing in the heading structure marks the form — which is the entire content of the page.

FIX

The T29 label change and C29's new section together resolve this naturally:

```
H1  Write to me about what's on your mind — I'll reply personally
H2  What's on your mind?          above the form
H2  What this usually looks like  the examples from C29
H2  Stay up to date in your inbox
H3  Got it. 🙏          success card, nested correctly
```

C31 The privacy policy is linked in the footer, not at the send button

MEDIUM

NOW — MEASURED

```
privacy links on the page:    1, in the footer
privacy link inside the form: none
```

The form asks for maximum candour — *"Say whatever's on your mind. The more honest, the more I can help."* — and collects free-text personal disclosure plus an email address.

The policy itself is good. I checked: `privacy.html` covers the Reflect form specifically, names Formsfree, and explains what happens to a message. That was done properly in pass 1. It is just linked in the one place nobody looks at the moment they hesitate.

FIX

`.reflect-note` already sits directly under the submit button and already says the right thing. Add four words and a link:

```
<p class="reflect-note">Private. I read every one. I'll reply by email –
  usually within a few days. <a href="privacy.html">What I do with your
  message</a>.</p>
```

It costs nothing, it makes work you have already done visible where it counts, and on a page asking for personal disclosure it is the difference between "trust me" and "here is why you can".

C32 Nowhere to go for the reader who is not ready to write

LOW

Same as **C25** on the book page. Apart from the nav, footer and "← Home" eyebrow, the body links nowhere. Someone who reads the offer, is interested, but is not ready to type something personal to a stranger today has one option: leave.

Add a closing line linking to the essays — ideally by topic, matching the four chips. "Not ready to write? Start with the essays on relationships." That converts a hesitant visitor into a reader instead of a bounce, and gives this page its first internal links with descriptive anchor text.

C. Tracking & measurement

K18 You measure completions but not attempts

MEDIUM

NOW

```
track("reflect-submit-" + category, "Reflection sent") ✓ implemented
```

The per-category breakdown is genuinely useful and was the right thing to build first. What is missing is everything before the submit.

WHY IT MATTERS

This form asks for more than any other on the site — a personal disclosure *and* an email address, from someone who may have arrived two minutes ago. The abandonment rate is therefore the number that tells you whether the ask is too large, and you currently cannot see it. Ten submissions could be ten attempts or two hundred.

Second gap: chips *clicked* versus chips *submitted*. That difference tells you what people arrive wanting to talk about versus what they actually go through with — and those are rarely the same on a page like this.

FIX

```
// 1. form start — fires once, on the first keystroke
document.getElementById("reflect-answer")
  ?.addEventListener("input", () => track("reflect-start", "Started writing"),
    { once: true });

// 2. topic selection, in the existing chip click handler
track("reflect-topic-" + chip.dataset.cat, "Topic chosen");
```

reflect-start → reflect-submit-* is your funnel. If starts are high and submits are low, the email field is the most likely blocker and is worth testing as optional-with-a-note. If starts themselves are low, the problem is **C27/C29** — nobody is finding the page or nobody believes it.

K19 Verified working — and it already answers a question worth asking

PASS

- reflect-submit-<category> fires on success, with the chosen topic ✓
- entryContext() — landing page, referrer, query — is spread into the Formsfree payload ✓

Worth pointing out because it is easy to miss: **that second one means every reflection you receive already tells you where the person came from.** "Do these arrive from the homepage Explore card, from the nav, or from search?" is answerable today, from the Formsfree inbox alone, with no additional work. That is a question most sites cannot answer at all.

C33 What is already right here — protect it KEEP

- **The form is well constructed.** `required` on the message and email, name deliberately optional, correct `autocomplete` tokens on both, a real `<button type="submit">`, `role="group"` with `aria-label="Choose a topic"` on the chips, and a 6-row textarea that visually invites a real answer rather than a sentence.
- **The expectation-setting is honest and specific.** "I read every one. I'll reply by email — usually within a few days." Specificity is what makes a generous promise believable, and most sites hedge exactly here.
- **The offer is genuinely distinctive.** Free, personal, from a named human. Nothing in this report suggests changing it — only that far too few people can currently find it.
- **Privacy coverage exists and is real** — `privacy.html` names this form and this processor. **C31** is only about where it is linked from.
- **The topic chips are the taxonomy** the archive still needs (**C18**, page 02). Four categories that reflect how you actually think about the subject, already built and already collecting data on which ones people pick.

Evidence log

Check	Result
Repo vs main	<code>main</code> unchanged at <code>c0a998a</code> — page-03 findings still open
Static text in <code><body></code>	166 words · rendered: 140 (the hidden success card accounts for the difference)
Title / description	28 chars / 99 chars
Headings	H1 → H3 → H2 — level skipped, then reversed; no heading marks the form
JSON-LD	0 blocks
Form labels	0 <code><label></code> elements · all three visible fields resolve to <code>PLACEHOLDER ONLY</code>
Topic chips	<code>type="button"</code> , <code>aria-pressed: null</code> on all four · container <code>role="group"</code> + <code>aria-label</code> correct
Success region	<code>#reflect-thanks</code> — <code>aria-live: null</code> , <code>role: null</code>
Privacy links	1, in the footer · none inside the form
<code>privacy.html</code> coverage	Names the Reflect form and Formspree explicitly ✓
Tracking	<code>reflect-submit-<category></code> ✓ · <code>entryContext()</code> in payload ✓ · no start or chip-selection event
Form validation	<code>required</code> on message + email · <code>autocomplete="given-name"</code> / <code>"email"</code> · real submit button

Page 04 of 7 complete. Remaining: `about.html` · `404.html` · `privacy.html`.

Still open from earlier passes and cross-referenced rather than repeated: **T22** (public chapter PDF — the only Critical outstanding), **T23**, **C20**, **C21** from page 03; **T2**, **C4**, **T13** site-wide.

The UI track remains one page behind: `ui/changelog-02-articles.pdf` is pending.

blakecody.com SEO change log · generated 6 September 2026